The Lighthouse Keeper

Ada Example

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CHAPTER ONE

The Lighthouse

Mara climbed the stairs of the old lighthouse every morning before the town woke, counting the steps as her grandmother had taught her.

The lamp had not been lit for *twenty* years, but she polished the brass anyway. Somebody had to remember how it was done, she thought.

* * *

By noon the fog had lifted and the harbourmaster came looking for her with news that would change everything in the village.

CHAPTER TWO

Strangers

The ship arrived on a Tuesday, which nobody liked, because Tuesdays were for mending nets and arguing about the weather.

Its captain was a tall woman with a voice like gravel, and she asked for Mara by name before she had even stepped ashore.

CHAPTER THREE

The Map

Inside the captain's cabin a map lay open across the table, its edges held down by four smooth stones from a distant beach.

Mara recognised the coastline at once. It was her own, drawn with extraordinary care by someone who had walked every mile of it.